If you controlled Dark Eras 2...



Cinder
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1408

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01-28-2016, 06:59 AM #61

I've been vouching for a Beast Dark Era in the Congo Free State since the Kickstarter and now that I've read some real books about it aside Heart of Darkness, I only want it more.

The events of the era lend themselves perfectly to examine how the evils of civilization interact with the darker side of human nature in a context that many agree was somehow detached from the rest of the world, as if you entered another dimension with its own rules. Things aren't even as simple as putting "colonizers vs natives", it's all a complex shade of greys where everyone is influenced by the atrocities that happen everywhere and respond to according to their experience.

When you put Beast and Heroes into into this context, their presence and own narratives both highlight the conflict of the age and the themes of the gameline, living nightmares and those who hunt them doing their thing while the world around them seems to be returning to a primordial state itself, the brutality of day-to-day actions striding violently with the facade of civilization (and not always in the way one would expect). Beasts in Congo will have to deal with the fact that their Family is scattered across all the local factions, whether they like it or not. With the rules of society fading away the deeper you get up the river, feeding and hunting becomes quite easy, perhaps too much. And then there are Heroes, who can do pretty much whatever they want when going after Beasts, if they opt to do so. It's almost as if the Primordial Dream is trying to merge with the physical world, around here. Slipping away and falling prey to the currents of nightmare is a costant danger.

Yeah, the core concept is pretty straightforward: Heart of Darkness meets Beast. But, then again, it does not mean it would be bad.

You also get the to have other some supernaturals based on the traditions of Central Africa, which is a bonus. There's some seriously cool stuff about undead, spirits & shapechangers and fairytales down there.

Last edited by Cinder; 01-28-2016, 09:40 AM.

Cinder's Comprehensive Collection of Creations - Homebrew Hub

I write about Beast: The Primordial a lot

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nofather
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 11016

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01-28-2016, 08:25 AM #62

Werewolf Vietnam. I wanted it before second edition, it makes more sense now.

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atamajakki
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 5487

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01-28-2016, 07:46 PM #63

> *Originally posted by* ***nofather***
> *Werewolf Vietnam. I wanted it before second edition, it makes more sense now.*

I'd sooner see it as a Mage setting, honestly, albeit with the situation back home included as well.

Remi. she/her. game designer.

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nofather
Member

01-28-2016, 08:21 PM #64

That's great. I'd rather have Vietnam focus on Vietnam, though. And werewolves.

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 11016

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01-29-2016, 02:05 AM #65

Are the werewolves doing anything in particular or just hanging out?

Michael
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 3559

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01-29-2016, 08:52 AM #66

You could have them just hang out, if that's how you run things. But the bulk of it would be about participating on one of the various sides of the Vietnam War, which used a country that had just gained its independence from the French and Japanese and was in the middle of a civil war as a staging ground for the worlds two foremost ideologies. There were soldiers and support from all over the globe, it wasn't something only America was involved in.

The Hisil is in chaos from all the uproar, native and foreign werewolves are there, they may be patriots, they may just be doing what they have to do or conscripted, but the Wolf Must Hunt, and the People Do Not Murder The People. It isn't the Pure on one side and the Forsaken on another, members of both factions find themselves on opposite sides of a gun and a goal, with human and wolf-blooded packmates all around, far easier to be killed than the Uratha. And even if the bullets aren't going to kill you there's the extensive use of chemical warfare, further tearing apart the Hisil and posing a threat to even the werewolves.

Azlu and beshilu by the truckload, spirits trying to escape the chaos by rushing into the material world, people shaken by war an easy host for claimed and shartha alike, balancing a need for werewolf packmates with the sometimes burden of more fragile, human ones in a strange, foreign land, or one you were born and raised in and is suddenly drowning in hostile invaders.

It's ripe for high tension, frenetic, werewolf storytelling.

Last edited by nofather; 01-29-2016, 09:05 AM.

nofather
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 11016

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AceOfAlmonds
Member

Join Date: Apr 2015
Posts: 323

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01-29-2016, 09:54 AM #67

I kinda want Demon for Age of Piracy. Think of it: the G-M's entrenched in the Old World, but maybe, just maybe, there's a slice of hell in the sea where it hasn't spread its mechanized tendrils yet. Saboteurs can run raids against shipping Infrastructure, Investigators can explore new and strange cultures and creatures in the New World, Integrators get a chance to spread their words into lands with less influence (or find the machinations of their killer god in unexpected locals), and there's always a down-and-out (or drunk-and-delirious) in a port city ripe for a Tempter's offer of a Soul Pact. Spending months on a small wooden boat will test just how good your Cover is, but hey, no landlubber takes a pirate's word of strange happenings as true, and those Glitches may not stand out against the guy whose beard is literally smoking all the time. Or maybe he's a Demon, too; best not to speculate, really.

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Vent0
Member
★★★★★

Join Date: Aug 2015
Posts: 5184

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01-29-2016, 11:52 PM #68

> *Originally posted by* ***AceOfAlmonds***
> *I kinda want Demon for Age of Piracy. Think of it: the G-M's entrenched in the Old World, but maybe, just maybe, there's a slice of hell in the sea where it hasn't spread its mechanized tendrils yet. Saboteurs can run raids against shipping Infrastructure, Investigators can explore new and strange cultures and creatures in the New World, Integrators get a chance to spread their words into lands with less influence (or find the machinations of their killer god in unexpected locals), and there's always a down-and-out (or drunk-and-delirious) in a port city ripe for a Tempter's offer of a Soul Pact. Spending months on a small wooden boat will test just how good your Cover is, but hey, no landlubber takes a pirate's word of strange happenings as true, and those Glitches may not stand out against the guy whose beard is literally smoking all the time. Or maybe he's a Demon, too; best not to speculate, really.*

Heh. I was thinking that too. Even was designing an Embed (tentatively called No Witnesses) that would eliminate Compromise rolls for acting out of character/being revealed as a Demon if no witnesses survive the scene (enabling a Demon Pirate to really cut loose on raids).

Malkydel: "And the Machine dictated; let there be adequate illumination."
Yossarian: "And lo, it was optimal."

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01-30-2016, 03:53 PM #69



Eremite
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 355

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> *Originally posted by* ***AceOfAlmonds***
> *I kinda want Demon for Age of Piracy. Think of it: the G-M's entrenched in the Old World, but maybe, just maybe, there's a slice of hell in the sea where it hasn't spread its mechanized tendrils yet. Saboteurs can run raids against shipping Infrastructure, Investigators can explore new and strange cultures and creatures in the New World, Integrators get a chance to spread their words into lands with less influence (or find the machinations of their killer god in unexpected locals), and there's always a down-and-out (or drunk-and-delirious) in a port city ripe for a Tempter's offer of a Soul Pact. Spending months on a small wooden boat will test just how good your Cover is, but hey, no landlubber takes a pirate's word of strange happenings as true, and those Glitches may not stand out against the guy whose beard is literally smoking all the time. Or maybe he's a Demon, too; best not to speculate, really.*

I adore this, partly as one can easily cast various English, Spanish and Dutch companies as Infrastructure...

Onyx Path Freelancer: Demon Storyteller's Guide, Dark Eras, Night Horrors: Enemy Action
Storyteller's Guide Extra Material
After the Fall: Bonus Material

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AceOfAlmonds
Member

Join Date: Apr 2015
Posts: 323

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01-30-2016, 10:54 PM #70

> *Originally posted by* ***Vent0***
> *Heh. I was thinking that too. Even was designing an Embed (tentatively called No Witnesses) that would eliminate Compromise rolls for acting out of character/being revealed as a Demon if no witnesses survive the scene (enabling a Demon Pirate to really cut loose on raids).*

Ooh, that's a neat one. I just got stuck on putting Heart's Desire in a compass, so that it always points towards the thing you want most...

👍 2

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Vent0
Member

01-31-2016, 06:57 AM #71

> *Originally posted by* ***AceOfAlmonds***
>
> *Ooh, that's a neat one. I just got stuck on putting Heart's Desire in a compass, so that it always points towards the thing you want most...*

Join Date: Aug 2015
Posts: 5184

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Hmm. Heart's Desire just *tells* you what something wants most, without any additional information about the object/subject itself. Near Field, maybe?

Though a Lambda combining Heart's Desire and (maybe Tag & Release or Summon?) might work...

I wonder if a ship counts as a vehicle for the purposes of Demon Car...?

Malkydel: "And the Machine dictated; let there be adequate illumination."
Yossarian: "And lo, it was optimal."

1

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01-31-2016, 09:21 AM #72

ZealousChristian24

Member

Join Date: Jul 2014
Posts: 1796

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> *Originally posted by **Vent0***
> *I wonder if a ship counts as a vehicle for the purposes of Demon Car...?*

If it's wrong, I don't want to be right!

2

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